

VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™

Protocol ID: VALIDOS-4LVP **Architecture:** VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture **Category:** AI & Interpretation **Subcategory:** Validation Governance **Type:** Operational Validation Protocol **Governed Space:** Four-Layer Validation Execution **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Canonical · Open Protocol **Effective Date:** 13 August 2026 **Authority:** OOF® **Protection:** MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property **AI-Readable:** Yes **Canonical Language:** English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™ (4LVP™) defines a four-layer operational protocol for determining whether a Validation Object has been sufficiently identified, evidentially supported, methodologically examined, formally determined, and bounded for legitimate validation reliance.

The protocol requires every Full Protocol Validation to pass through four mandatory validation layers:

Layer 1 — Object & Scope Validation

Layer 2 — Evidence & Source Validation

Layer 3 — Execution & Determination Validation

Layer 4 — State & Reliance Validation

Each layer produces a governed output that becomes an input to the next layer.

No Full Protocol Validation Claim may exceed the weakest unresolved material layer upon which that claim depends.

Protocol Purpose

The purpose of 4LVP™ is to transform the broader VALIDOS® architecture into a compact, repeatable, auditable validation sequence.

VALIDOS® defines the complete governance architecture of validation.

4LVP™ defines the minimum operational pathway through which a validation claim may be produced under the protocol.

The protocol is designed to prevent:

- undefined Validation Objects,
 - hidden scope expansion,
 - unsupported evidence,
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- unreliable sources,
- methodological substitution,
- incomplete execution,
- predetermined conclusions,
- validation-state inflation,
- unrestricted reliance,
- silent layer skipping,
- hidden exceptions,
- and claims of Full Protocol Conformity without completion of the required validation pathway.

Core Protocol Principle

No validation claim may exceed the weakest unresolved validation layer on which that claim materially depends.

Protocol Flow

Validation Object

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Layer 1 — Object & Scope Validation

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Gate 1 — Validation Basis Defined

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Layer 2 — Evidence & Source Validation

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Gate 2 — Validation Basis Supported

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Layer 3 — Execution & Determination Validation

↓

Gate 3 — Validation Conclusion Established

↓

Layer 4 — State & Reliance Validation

↓

Gate 4 — Validation Claim Bounded

Layer 1 — Object & Scope Validation

Core Question

What exactly is being validated, for what purpose, against which boundaries, and at what intended level of validation?

Layer 1 establishes the identity and boundaries of the validation inquiry.

A Validation Object must not enter the protocol as an undefined concept.

Mandatory Elements

Layer 1 must establish:

Validation Object

The exact object, claim, model, system, dataset, method, process, product, prediction, simulation, output, decision, or other entity being validated.

Object Identity

The version, configuration, state, or other attributes necessary to distinguish the object from materially different objects.

Validation Purpose

Why validation is being performed.

Validation Scope

What is included and excluded.

Validation Criteria Basis

What requirements, properties, expectations, thresholds, or validation questions the object must be examined against.

Validation Depth

The intended assurance strength relative to the purpose and consequence of reliance.

Layer 1 Prohibitions

Layer 1 prohibits:

- undefined objects,
- ambiguous object versions,

- retrospective scope expansion,
- validation against undisclosed criteria,
- purpose substitution,
- and presenting a partial validation scope as whole-object validation.

Layer 1 Output

Validation Object & Scope Record

The record must be sufficiently precise for an independent reviewer to determine:

what was validated

and: **what was not validated.**

Gate 1 — Validation Basis Defined

Layer 1 passes only where the Validation Object, purpose, scope, criteria basis, and intended depth are sufficiently defined.

Possible Gate 1 outcomes:

PASS

CONDITIONAL PASS

FAIL

UNDETERMINED

A FAIL or materially unresolved UNDETERMINED result prevents Full Protocol Conformity.

Layer 2 — Evidence & Source Validation

Core Question

Is the validation basis supported by evidence and sources that are sufficiently relevant, reliable, complete, current, independent where necessary, and traceable for the intended validation claim?

Layer 2 governs what the validation will rely upon.

Evidence quantity alone is insufficient.

Source authority alone is insufficient.

The validation basis must be fit for the actual validation question.

Mandatory Elements

Layer 2 must establish:

Evidence Relevance

Does the evidence actually address the Validation Criteria?

Evidence Sufficiency

Is there enough evidence to support the intended validation depth?

Evidence Quality

Is the evidence accurate, usable, representative, and methodologically appropriate?

Evidence Currency

Is the evidence sufficiently current for the object and purpose?

Evidence Completeness

Are material evidence gaps visible?

Source Identity

Who or what produced the evidence?

Source Capability Was the source capable of producing reliable evidence for this question?

Source Reliability

Is the source sufficiently trustworthy within the relevant context?

Source Independence

Where independence materially affects assurance, is independence sufficient or is dependency disclosed?

Evidence-to-Source Traceability

Can material evidence be connected to its source and origin?

Contradictory Evidence Rule

Material contradictory evidence must not be omitted merely because it weakens the expected validation conclusion.

Contradiction must be:

included,

classified,

assessed,

and:

carried forward into determination.

Missing Evidence Rule

Missing material evidence must not be converted into positive evidence.

Where a required evidence basis is absent:

absence must remain visible.

Layer 2 Output

Validated Evidence & Source Basis

The output identifies:

- accepted evidence,
- conditionally accepted evidence,
- rejected evidence,
- material source limitations,
- unresolved evidence gaps,
- contradictions,
- and the resulting evidence sufficiency status.

Gate 2 — Validation Basis Supported

Layer 2 passes only where the evidence and source basis is sufficient for the Validation Purpose, Scope, Criteria, and Depth established in Layer 1.

Possible Gate 2 outcomes:

PASS

CONDITIONAL PASS FAIL

UNDETERMINED

A validation claim may not be stronger than the evidence and source basis supporting it.

Layer 3 — Execution & Determination Validation

Core Question

Was the validation actually performed according to an appropriate method, and what conclusion does the resulting validation record

legitimately support?

Layer 3 separates:

having evidence

from:

having performed validation.

Evidence does not become a validation determination automatically.

Mandatory Elements

Layer 3 must establish:

Validation Method

The procedure by which the criteria will be assessed.

Method Applicability

The method must fit the Validation Object and validation question.

Execution Conformity

The approved method must be executed sufficiently as defined.

Execution Traceability

Material validation actions and observations must
be reconstructable.

Deviation Governance

Material deviations from the method must be recorded and assessed.

Negative Result Preservation

Failed criteria, adverse results, and unresolved observations must
remain part of the record.

Determination Logic

The final determination must follow from the validated evidence and
execution record.

Determination Outcomes

A validation determination may be:

Positive

The applicable validation basis supports the defined criteria
within scope.

Conditional The conclusion is supported only while explicit conditions remain true.

Partial

Only defined portions of the Validation Object or Scope are supported.

Negative

One or more material validation requirements are not satisfied.

Indeterminate

The available validation basis does not support a legitimate positive or negative conclusion.

Conflicted

Materially credible validation paths produce incompatible conclusions that cannot yet be reconciled.

No Predetermined Outcome Rule

A validation process must remain capable of producing a negative or indeterminate result.

A process designed so that only a positive conclusion is practically permitted does not satisfy Full Protocol Conformity.

Layer 3 Output

Validation Determination Record

The record must connect:

**Criteria → Evidence → Sources → Method → Execution → Result
→ Determination**

Gate 3 — Validation Conclusion Established

Layer 3 passes when the determination is methodologically supported and bounded by the actual validation record.

Gate 3 does not require a Positive Determination.

A Negative or Indeterminate Determination may still represent a correctly executed protocol.

Possible Gate 3 outcomes:

PASS — Determination Established

CONDITIONAL PASS

FAIL — Determination Unsupported

UNDETERMINED

Layer 4 — State & Reliance Validation

Core Question

What Validation State does the object now legitimately hold, what may be relied upon, under which conditions, and when must validation be reconsidered?

Layer 4 prevents a valid determination from becoming unlimited permission.

Mandatory Elements Layer 4 must establish:

Validation State

The current validation condition of the object.

Possible states may include:

Validated

Conditionally Validated

Partially Validated

Validation Pending

Validation Conflicted

Validation Suspended

Validation Expired

Invalidated

Revalidation Required

Reliance Scope

What the validation may legitimately support.

Reliance Purpose

For what use may the validation be relied upon?

Reliance Conditions

Which conditions must remain satisfied?

Reliance Restrictions

Which uses remain outside the validation claim?

Reliance Duration

For how long may reliance continue?

Revalidation Triggers

Which changes require reassessment or revalidation?

Reliance Boundary Rule

Validation State ≠ Universal Reliance Authorization

A Validation State may support one reliance context and be insufficient for another.

Change Rule

Material change in:

- object,
- version,
- scope,
- environment,
- population,
- evidence,
- source reliability,
- method,
- dependencies,
- autonomy,
- consequence,
- or intended use

must trigger an assessment of whether the current Validation State remains applicable.

Layer 4 Output

Validation State & Reliance Record

The record identifies:

- current Validation State,
- applicable scope,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- reliance eligibility,
- validity duration,
- revalidation triggers,
- and unresolved limitations.

Gate 4 — Validation Claim Bounded

Layer 4 passes only where the resulting validation claim is no broader than the state and reliance basis actually established.

Possible Gate 4 outcomes:

PASS

CONDITIONAL PASS

FAIL

UNDETERMINED

Full Protocol Conformity Rule

A validation may claim:

VALIDOS® Four-Layer Validation Protocol — Full Protocol Conformity

only where:

- 1. all four layers were addressed;
 - 2. all mandatory material elements were assessed;
 - 3. every applicable Gate was completed;
 - 4. material exceptions were disclosed;
 - 5. unresolved conditions were preserved;
 - 6. no material layer was silently skipped;
 - 7. the final claim does not exceed the weakest materially relevant layer outcome;
 - 8. sufficient traceability exists to reconstruct the validation path.
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Independent Layer Use Rule

Any individual layer may be used independently.

Independent use must be labeled as:

Layer-Specific Application

or another equivalent non-conformity representation.

Independent layer use does **not** permit a claim of Full Protocol Conformity.

Non-Applicable Layer Rule

A layer may be classified:

Not Applicable

only where:

- non-applicability is explicitly declared,
- the reason is documented,
- the exclusion does not remove a material validation dependency,
- and the resulting validation claim is correspondingly bounded.

A layer must never become effectively absent merely because it was not convenient to perform.

No Silent Layer Skipping Rule

A Full Protocol Validation may not silently bypass any mandatory layer.

Every layer must have a recorded status:

PASS

CONDITIONAL PASS

FAIL

UNDETERMINED

or:

NOT APPLICABLE — JUSTIFIED

No Layer Substitution Rule

One layer may not substitute for another.

For example:

Strong Evidence

cannot substitute for:

Correct Validation Execution.

Expert Opinion

cannot substitute for:

Missing Material Evidence.

Positive Execution Results

cannot substitute for: **Defined Scope.**

Validated State

cannot substitute for:

Reliance Eligibility.

No Upward Claim Rule

The final validation claim may never exceed the strongest claim supported by all materially relevant layers.

Conceptually:

Final Validation Claim $\leq$ Weakest Material Validation Layer

Weakest Material Layer Rule

Where a materially relevant layer remains:

Conditional

Partial

Failed

or:

Undetermined

the final validation claim must reflect that limitation.

Example:

Layer 1: PASS

Layer 2: CONDITIONAL PASS

Layer 3: PASS

Layer 4: PASS

The final validation may not be represented as unrestricted validation if Layer 2 remains materially conditional.

No Hidden Exception Rule

Every material exception must be:

- identified,
- classified,
- justified,
- linked to the affected layer,
- and reflected in the final validation claim.

An undisclosed material exception invalidates Full Protocol Conformity.

Negative Evidence Preservation Rule

Negative evidence may not be removed from the validation record merely because it conflicts with the desired result.

Material negative evidence must remain traceable into:

Layer 3 Determination

and:

Layer 4 State & Reliance.

No Evidence Laundering Rule

Evidence rejected or materially downgraded in Layer 2 may not re-enter Layer 3 as if it had passed validation.

Any reuse requires an explicit reassessment.

No Scope Inflation Rule

Validation scope may not expand between layers without returning to Layer 1 for scope reassessment.

No Determination Inflation Rule

A:

Conditional Determination

cannot become:

Unrestricted Validated State

without a governed basis resolving the relevant conditions.

A:

Partial Determination

cannot become:

Whole-Object Validation.

No Reliance Inflation Rule

A validated object may not be relied upon outside:

- validated scope,
- validated purpose,
- current state,
- applicable conditions,
- permitted consequence,
- and validity period

without additional assessment.

Protocol Comparability Rule

Two validation outcomes may be represented as **Protocol-Comparable** only where the comparison discloses and sufficiently aligns:

- Validation Object class,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Criteria basis,
- Validation Depth,
- completed layers,
- Gate outcomes,
- material evidence requirements,
- material source requirements,
- unresolved exceptions,
- state classification,
- and reliance boundaries.

Results using materially different protocol scopes must not be represented as equivalent merely because both use the word:

Validated.

Comparability Disclosure

Where two validations differ materially, the difference must be explicit.

Possible representation:

Fully Comparable

Conditionally Comparable

Partially Comparable

Not Comparable

or:

Comparability Undetermined

Protocol Conformity Status

A completed protocol may receive one of the following conformity statuses:

Full Protocol Conformity

All mandatory layers and Gates satisfy the protocol requirements and the final claim remains within the validated basis.

Conditional Protocol Conformity

The protocol was completed but one or more material conditions remain attached to the validation claim.

Partial Protocol Conformity

The protocol was completed only for an explicitly bounded portion of the Validation Object or Scope.

Protocol Non-Conformity

One or more mandatory requirements were not satisfied.

Protocol Conformity Undetermined

Available records are insufficient to determine whether the protocol was correctly completed.

Protocol Failure Conditions

Full Protocol Conformity must not be declared where any of the following occurs:

- material Validation Object ambiguity,
 - undisclosed scope change,
 - missing material criteria,
 - material evidence insufficiency,
 - materially unreliable sources,
 - hidden contradictory evidence,
 - invalid or unsuitable Validation Method,
 - materially incomplete execution,
 - undisclosed execution deviation,
 - predetermined validation outcome,
 - unsupported Validation Determination,
-

- validation-state inflation,
- undisclosed reliance expansion,
- material layer skipping,
- hidden Not Applicable classification,
- missing traceability,
- or unresolved material exceptions inconsistent with the declared claim.

Protocol Revalidation Rule

A completed protocol does not establish permanent validation.

Material change may require:

Layer Reassessment

Targeted Revalidation

Partial Revalidation

or:

Full Protocol Revalidation

depending upon the affected validation basis.

Revalidation should begin at the earliest materially affected layer.

Protocol Re-Entry Rule

Examples:

Object changes materially

→ return to **Layer 1**

Evidence or source basis changes materially

→ return to **Layer 2**

Method or execution changes materially

→ return to **Layer 3**

State, reliance context, conditions, or consequence changes materially

→ return to **Layer 4** Affected downstream layers must then be reassessed.

Minimum Protocol Record

Every Full Protocol Validation must preserve at minimum:

Protocol Validation ID

Validation Object

Object Version / Configuration

Validation Purpose

Validation Scope

Validation Criteria Basis

Validation Depth

Layer 1 Status

Layer 2 Status

Layer 3 Status

Layer 4 Status

Gate 1 Status

Gate 2 Status

Gate 3 Status

Gate 4 Status

Material Evidence Basis

Material Sources

Validation Method

Validation Determination

Validation State

Reliance Scope

Conditions

Restrictions

Material Exceptions

Revalidation Triggers

Protocol Conformity Status

Validation Date

and sufficient traceability to reconstruct the protocol.

Compact Protocol Decision Logic

A Full Protocol Validation asks four sequential questions: **Layer 1**

Do we know exactly what we are validating and what the claim is allowed to cover?

If no:

STOP / RESOLVE

Layer 2

Do we possess a sufficiently reliable evidence and source basis for that claim?

If no:

RESTRICT / FAIL / REMAIN UNDETERMINED

Layer 3

Was validation properly executed, and what conclusion does the record actually support?

If unsupported:

NO POSITIVE VALIDATION CLAIM

Layer 4

What may legitimately be claimed and relied upon now?

The final claim must remain within:

Object + Scope + Evidence + Sources + Execution + Determination + State + Reliance Boundary

Protocol Result Formula

Conceptually:

Validation Claim Strength

is bounded by:

Object & Scope Integrity

×

Evidence & Source Sufficiency

×

Execution & Determination Integrity

×

State & Reliance Applicability

This formula is conceptual, not numerical.

A material failure in one required layer cannot be compensated for by excessive strength in another.

Protocol Conformity Statement

A compliant validation record may state: **This validation was conducted in accordance with VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™ v1.0 within the declared Validation Object, Purpose, Scope, Criteria, Validation Depth, conditions, restrictions, and protocol record.**

Where conformity is conditional or partial, this must be stated explicitly.

Prohibited Conformity Statement

A validation must not state or imply:

Full VALIDOS® Four-Layer Protocol Validation

where:

- one or more mandatory layers were omitted,
- material Gates were not completed,
- required traceability is unavailable,
- or unresolved material limitations are inconsistent with the claim.

Architecture Relationship

4LVP™ is an operational protocol derived from:

VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

It does not replace the ten Parent Standards.

The four protocol layers compress the architecture into an operational validation path:

Layer 1 — Object & Scope

draws primarily from governance of:

Validation Object, Purpose, Scope, Criteria, and Validation Depth.

Layer 2 — Evidence & Sources

draws primarily from:

Validation Evidence Fitness and Validation Source Reliability.

Layer 3 — Execution & Determination

draws primarily from:

Validation Method, Validation Execution, and Validation Determination.

Layer 4 — State & Reliance

draws primarily from:

Validation State, Reliance, Monitoring, and Revalidation governance.

The Parent Standards remain the reference architecture.

4LVP™ is the execution protocol.

Protocol Modularity Principle

Layers may operate independently. Protocol conformity may not.

This allows modular use without weakening the meaning of Full Protocol Validation.

Protocol Integrity Principle

No layer may hide what another layer would materially need to know.

Material validation information must propagate forward through the protocol.

Protocol Comparability Principle

Two validation results are comparable only to the extent that their validation object, scope, depth, layer completion, gates, evidence basis, unresolved exceptions, and reliance boundaries are

themselves comparable.

Protocol Anti-Bypass Principle

A validation pathway may differ in implementation, but no implementation may claim full protocol conformity by removing a material validation requirement from visibility.

Foundational Principle

Validation becomes trustworthy when every material claim can be traced backward through state, determination, execution, evidence, sources, scope, and the exact object that was actually validated.

Canonical Closing Statement

VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™ establishes a compact operational validation pathway through four mandatory layers: Object & Scope Validation, Evidence & Source Validation, Execution & Determination Validation, and State & Reliance Validation. Through mandatory inter-layer Gates, explicit conformity states, anti-bypass rules, evidence preservation, scope control, determination boundaries, reliance limits, comparability requirements, revalidation triggers, and complete protocol traceability, **4LVP™** ensures that validation cannot become stronger merely by skipping difficult questions, hiding unresolved evidence, expanding scope, or converting a bounded validation result into unrestricted reliance. The protocol permits modular implementation while protecting the methodological meaning of Full Protocol Conformity: every validation claim must remain bounded by the weakest unresolved material layer upon which that claim depends.

Related Documents

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

[→ About VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

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